

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Phase 1: Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

1.1 Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in the handling of standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops frequently require a configuration step; however, this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to:

- Frustration among end users awaiting device readiness.
- Inefficient allocation of IT departmental resources.
- Inconsistent fulfillment of routine, repeatable procurement requests.

The absence of an automated mechanism to generate and route configuration tasks means that responsibility for follow-up relies on manual intervention, increasing the likelihood of errors and extending turnaround times for a high-volume, standardized service request.

1.2 User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, **I want** a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration, **so that** laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

This user story establishes the foundational requirement for the solution: the automation of task creation and assignment immediately following the approval of a standard laptop service request, thereby eliminating the manual coordination overhead currently borne by the procurement team.

1.3 Project Objectives

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

- **Create a seamless experience** for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration of devices upon arrival.
- **Reduce manual intervention** and the potential for errors in the procurement process through automated task generation and assignment.
- **Improve resource utilisation** within the IT department by optimising task allocation to the appropriate assignment group (Hardware).
- **Enhance overall efficiency and productivity** in IT procurement operations by replacing ad-hoc, manual coordination with a consistent, repeatable automated workflow.